

THOMAS SOUVERAIN

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EDUCATION

ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE – PHD IN AI ETHICS – EXPLAINABILITY & FAIRNESS

Paris • 2020 – 2024

Summa cum laude, PhD bridging industry and research (CIFRE), philosophy and computer science: “How AI Classifies Us: Explaining AI in financial services and hiring, from technical solutions to ethical challenges.” Visiting researcher:

- **STANFORD** – Causal constraints for graph neural networks, issued in a [repository](#). *Stanford • 01-04/2023*
- **OXFORD** – Transparent fairness for classifiers – Singapore hackathon finalist: [GitHub package](#). *Oxford • 09-12/2022*

ÉCOLE NORMALE SUPÉRIEURE – MPhil – PHILOSOPHY OF AI EXPLAINABILITY

Paris • 2018 – 2020

LYCÉE HENRI IV – INTENSIVE PROGRAM IN HUMANITIES, MATHEMATICS AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

Paris • 2015 – 2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FRENCH ALTERNATIVE ENERGIES AND ATOMIC ENERGY COMMISSION (CEA) – RESEARCH ENGINEER

Saclay • 2025 – 2026

Leads ethics and compliance for OpenLLM, a France 2030 public-private consortium developing an open, efficient, EU-compliant LLM for the French Ministry of Education.

- **End-to-end ethics and regulatory strategy across the LLM lifecycle** – data, training, alignment, deployment.
- **LLM evaluation – building education-specific benchmarks for the French context (toxicity, hallucinations).**
- **Team management:** supervised 2 interns in data science and cognitive science.
- **One of 50 European experts** consulted by the AI Office on standards for LLM labelling (expertise on watermarking).

FRANCE TRAVAIL – CIFRE PHD RESEARCHER

Nantes & Paris • 2025 – 2026

User research on AI adoption; designed and delivered internal AI ethics training programs.

- **Impact study** of AI and explainability used by recruitment advisors: qualitative phase (semi-structured interviews) across 5 agencies, then a quantitative study with 300 advisors. As an AFNOR member, feedback on EU norms.
- **Trained 350 employees** in applied ethics for hiring (data and product teams).

DREAMQUARK – DATA SCIENCE TEAM

Paris • 2020 – 2023

Built applied AI ethics code and helped shape strategy for the start-up DreamQuark, a pioneer in explainable AI for financial services (became Linedata SaaS AI Department). R&D in explainability and fairness in classification.

AI ETHICS OUTREACH – BRIDGING INDUSTRY & ACADEMIA

Paris • 2020 – 2026

- **Organized an international research-industry conference** (Paris Conference on AI and Digital Ethics, 2025 edition on disinformation and social cohesion, 200 attendees); led scientific selection and launched the associated [journal](#).
- **Designed hands-on and critical courses on ethics for MSc programs** in AI & cybersecurity (Sorbonne), digital law (Institut Catholique de Paris), and philosophy (École Normale Supérieure). [Kaggle example](#) on practical work on XAI.
- **Advised universities on digital transformation:** École Normale Supérieure ; Bordeaux Montaigne university ; Director of the “Digital Trust & Ethics” project team, Maison des Sciences Numériques – Sorbonne Paris Nord.
- **Leads the Ethics Working, Hub France IA;** coordinates startups and SMEs on best-practices guides.

PUBLICATIONS & COMMUNICATIONS

WHITE-PAPERS & PRACTICAL GUIDES FOR SAFE & RESPONSIBLE AI STRATEGIES

- Souverain, T., Grinbaum, A., & Klein, E. (2026). [Watermarking LLMs: feasibility, constraints, and strategies](#).
- Souverain, T., Duchemann, B., et al. (2023; 2024). [Opérationnaliser votre système d'IA avec une démarche éthique](#).
- Souverain, T., Meric, N. (2021). [State of Ethical AI: Challenges Posed by Ethics to Companies Developing AI](#).

PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS IN MACHINE-LEARNING & ETHICS JOURNALS

- Souverain, T., Égré, P. (2026, fc). [Fairness Interventions: A Study on AI Explainability](#). *Topoi* (top-Q1 journal).
- Souverain, T. (2025). [AI to renew public employment services? Explanation and trust of experts](#). *AI and Ethics*.
- Souverain, T. (2025). [L'IA générative, nouvelle idole ?](#). *Communio*, special issue on AI.
- Ledro, C., Nosella, A., Vinelli, A., Dalla Pozza, I., & Souverain, T. (2025). [Artificial intelligence in customer relationship management: A systematic framework for a successful integration](#). *Journal of Business Research*.

COMMUNICATIONS IN 40+ COMPANIES, NGOS, INSTITUTIONS ON RESPONSIBLE AI, EU SAFETY & EXPLAINABILITY CHALLENGES

EXTRACURRICULAR HIGHLIGHTS

ULTRA-TRAIL RUNNING – Verbier (140 km, 9300 m D+; winner of the 46 km race in 2022), Mont Blanc (100 km, 5800 D+)

SCOUTING – Led 10 young people aged 17 to 19; outreach support for people experiencing homelessness.

OTHER INTERESTS: Cuban salsa, Poetry, Acting (films broadcast on France 2).

SKILLS & INTERESTS

LANGUAGES: French (native), English (full professional proficiency), German (C1, fluent), Ancient Greek (reading).

MACHINE LEARNING: Tabular classification, scoring and churn prediction, multiclass NLP and LLMs in Python (expert), software development (VS Code, Git, Docker). OTHER SOFTWARE: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, LaTeX.